

BODY & SENSES GUIDE

ASCENSION

Discover your pathway

DA NANG, VIETNAM
JANUARY 12-26, 2027



EXCERPT

How I Learned to Listen

In 2003, my spine spoke. S1-L5 herniated disc. Real pain.

I chose something harder than surgery: attention.

Twenty-three years later—after working with John Sutherland's fascia research, forty days with Physician Loan's Vietnamese acupressure, studying the Rolfing lineage—I'm still moving. Still working. Not because my spine healed. Because I learned a different language for living inside it.

That's what this guide is about.





THE CHOICE

Not Surgery. Not Acceptance. Dialogue.

If your body has real damage—herniation, arthritis, limitation—there are three paths:

Surgical intervention. Acceptance. Dialogue.

I refused the first. Rejected the second. The third saved my life.

ASCENSION is built on this third path. Not “cure.” Not “transformation in fourteen days.” Instead: permission to hear what your body is asking for.

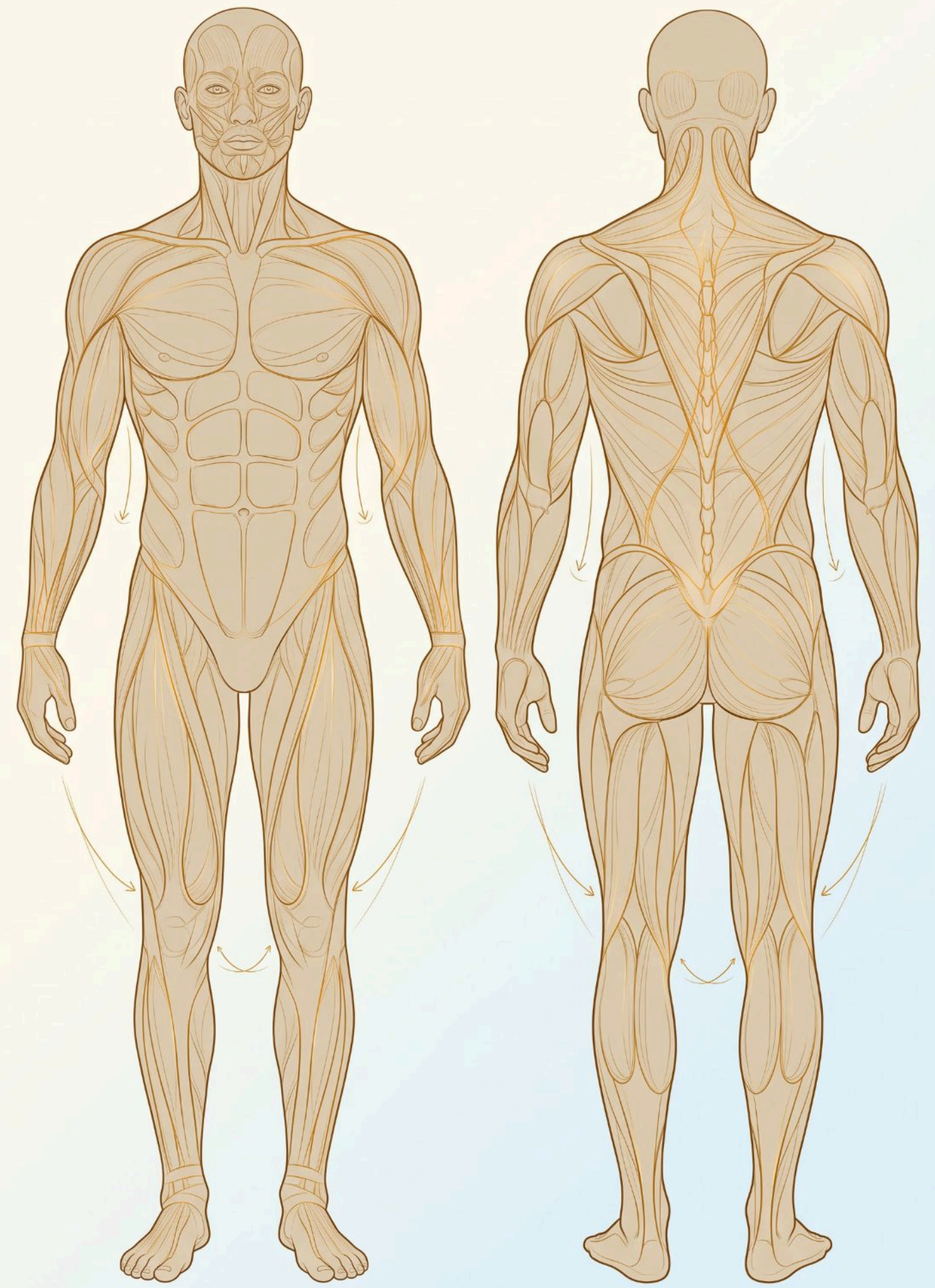
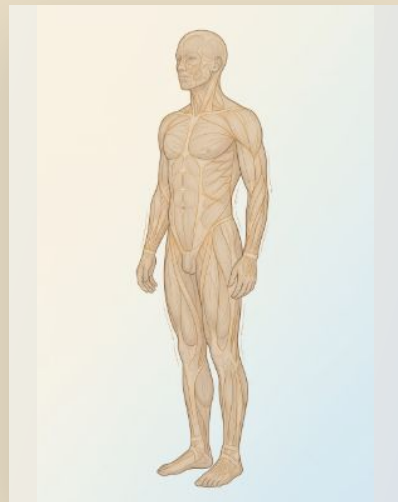
Why Fascia Matters

For fifteen years, I thought my pain lived in my spine. Then I learned it lived in the tissue around it.

Fascia is the connective tissue network woven through every part of you. It doesn't show up on imaging. But it's responsible for whether movement feels fluid or restricted, whether your body holds tension or releases it.

When John Sutherland taught me to work with fascia instead of against it, everything changed. Not because the arthritis disappeared. But because my body learned how to move through the limitation instead of fighting it.

Your body isn't broken. It's just forgotten how to ask for what it needs.





THE BREAKTHROUGH

Discovering Physician Loan

Twenty years into managing my spine, I thought I understood everything.

I was wrong.

I discovered Physician Loan's practice almost by accident. Vietnamese Điện Chấn—its own complete system. Its own body map. Its own sophisticated understanding of how the entire body connects through fascia.

I hired her for 40 consecutive days. Not casual sessions. Deep, committed work. Sessions that ran three, four, even longer hours.

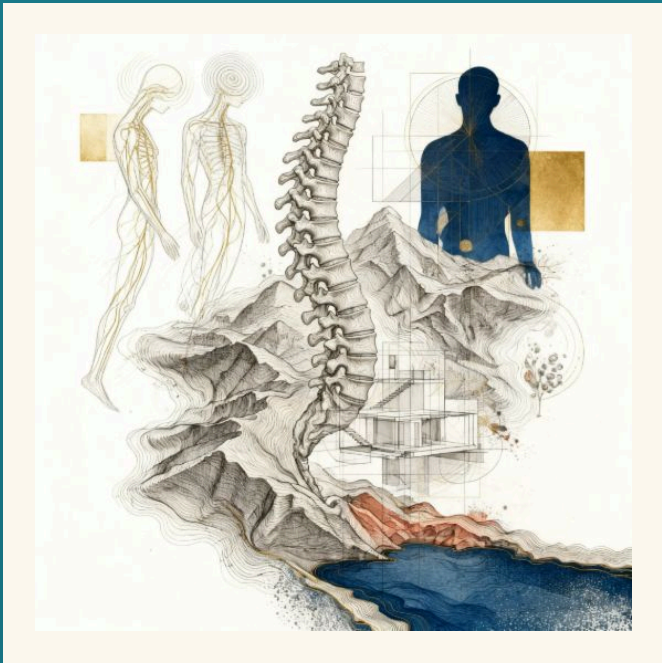
I documented everything. Before X-rays. After X-rays. Blood work tracking magnesium levels, inflammatory markers. Range of motion measurements.

The results were undeniable.

What happened over those 40 days wasn't subtle. Significant lightness. Dramatic pain reduction. Stuck points that had been locked for years finally released.

Not because the arthritis disappeared. But because my entire system reorganized itself.

The Six Pathways



Everything that follows is built on this principle: Your body knows. We're just creating permission for you to listen.

01

RESTORE

Recovery, restorative care and a more spacious rhythm.

02

EMBODY

Movement, mobility, touch and embodied awareness.

03

BREATHE

Breath, presence and the restorative character of place.

04

RESONATE

Listening environments, sound baths, music and stillness.

05

CREATE

Materials and practices that return participants to intuition.

06

TASTE

Vietnamese ingredients, shared tables and cultural discovery.

01 RESTORE

Rest as structural practice. Recovery as intelligence.

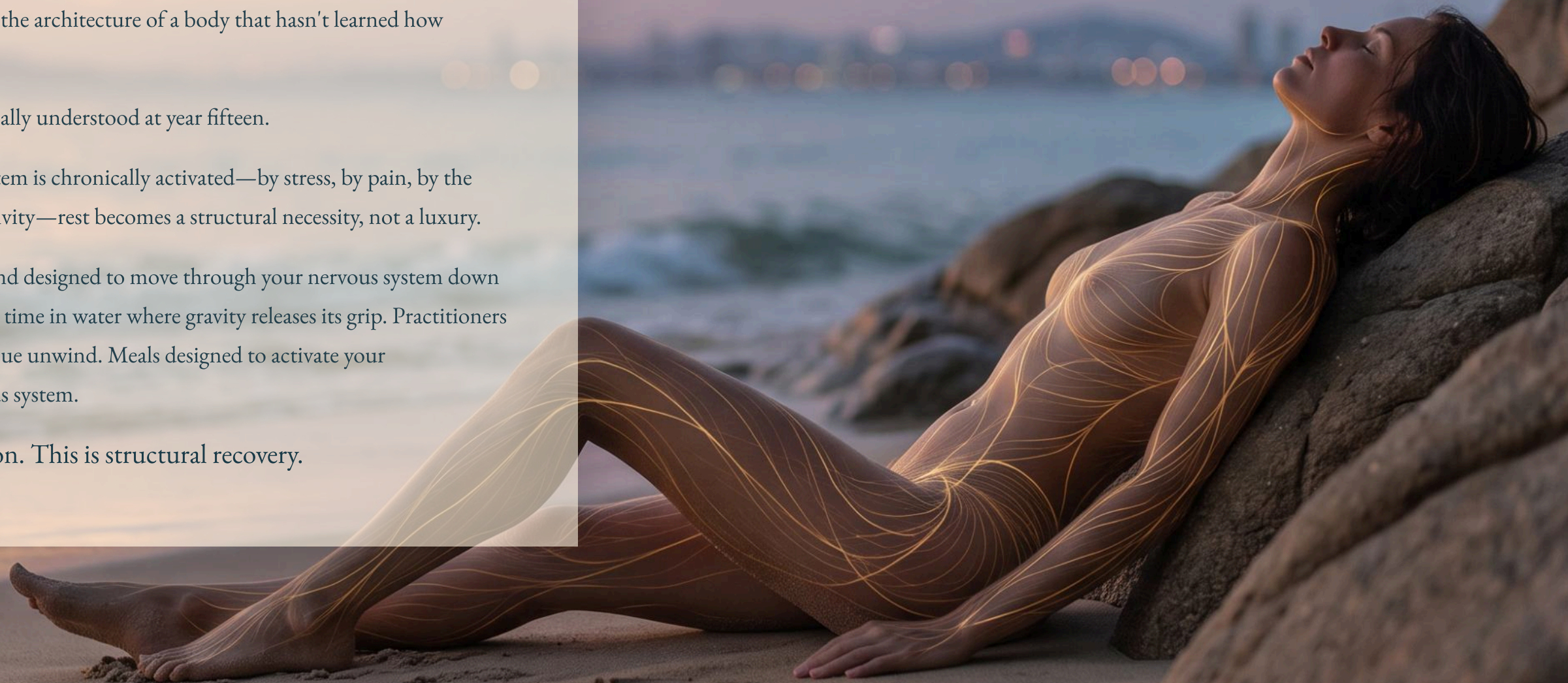
I spent twenty years pushing through pain. Holding tension in my jaw, shoulders, lower back—the architecture of a body that hasn't learned how to stop.

RESTORE is what I finally understood at year fifteen.

When your nervous system is chronically activated—by stress, by pain, by the momentum of productivity—rest becomes a structural necessity, not a luxury.

RESTORE means: sound designed to move through your nervous system down to tissue level. Extended time in water where gravity releases its grip. Practitioners trained in how to let tissue unwind. Meals designed to activate your parasympathetic nervous system.

This is not meditation. This is structural recovery.





02 EMBODY

Movement as conversation. Sensation as information.

Everything your body knows lives in your fascia.

EMBODY is for people who've lived primarily in their heads. Whose bodies have become instruments they drive rather than systems they inhabit.

When you're in ASCENSION, you're not doing isolated treatments. You're entering a system.

You have myofascial release work—understanding Western fascia anatomy, how patterns lock in, how intelligent touch can reorganize them.

Later the same day, you're with Physician Loan, working Vietnamese Điện Chấn. She's reading your body's map of connection. Understanding how your face reflects your internal organs. How shoulder tension connects to hip stability.

Your nervous system isn't confused. It's optimized. Two languages, same conversation. Same goal: helping your fascia remember fluidity.

Then you move. Ecstatic dance. Gentle exploration. Adaptive movement that lets your newly reorganized tissue discover what it can actually do.

This is what “working in concert” means.



03 BREATHE

Breath as anchor. Presence as geography.

Breath is the bridge between your voluntary and involuntary nervous system.

When I first started acupressure work, I realized my breath had been shallow for years. Not because something was wrong with my lungs. But because my nervous system was in low-level alert.

One good breath—full, extended, aware—changed my entire relationship with my spine.

BREATHE is for people who've forgotten how to be present. Who need permission to occupy one moment fully and let their nervous system downregulate in real time.

In ASCENSION, BREATHE means: breathwork that teaches your vagus nerve how to activate calm. Sound frequencies that slow your brainwave state. Time on the coast where the rhythm of the sea becomes your rhythm.



04 RESONATE

Sound as medicine. Listening as practice.

Sound moves through your fascia before you understand it intellectually.

RESONATE is for people overstimulated by noise. Hungry for frequencies that actually calm instead of agitate.

In ASCENSION, RESONATE means: gong baths where the vibration moves through your entire connective tissue system. Live improvisation with Vietnamese instruments. Silence cultivated so intentionally it becomes audible.

Fascia vibrates. Sound makes it vibrate differently. Different vibrations create different states in your body.

CREATE

Making as meditation. Intuition as somatic practice.

Your hands know things your mind hasn't learned yet.

CREATE is for people who've outsourced their intuition. Who've stopped making, stopped building, stopped discovering what wants to exist.

What I learned from fifteen years of bodywork is this: intuition isn't ethereal. It's somatic. Your hands have intelligence your brain hasn't caught up to yet.

In ASCENSION, CREATE means: materials placed in your hands—paper, pigment, clay, fiber. Not for outcomes. For the conversation between your hands and what they touch.

Your fascia is a sensory organ. Using your hands as a sensory practice is a way of letting your whole body think.



06 TASTE

Eating as culture. Nourishment as place.

Food moves through your body as information, not just calories.

TASTE is for people who've eaten on the go. Who want to remember that eating—slow eating, attentive eating—is a practice that roots you in where you actually are.

In ASCENSION, TASTE means: Vietnamese kitchens opened to you. Ingredients you've never held. Meals prepared so you can taste the place they came from.

How you eat—the speed, the attention, the presence—shapes whether your entire system is organized around stress or ease.

THE RHYTHM

Your Fourteen Days in Da Nang

Each morning begins the same way:

- Physician Loan's Điện Chẩn (acupressure and cupping)
- Movement practice aligned with your pathway
- Sound healing as transition



AFTERNOONS

Afternoons shift by day: fascial release, creative practice, sound immersion, or guided exploration of the city and surrounding landscape.



EVENINGS

Evenings gather everyone: ecstatic dance by the sea (sunset), communal meals built around Vietnamese ingredients, sound baths or silence.



EVERY FOURTH DAY

Every fourth day is a reset: extended rest, optional Marble Mountains excursion, reflection and integration.

PLACE

The Body Is Not Separate From Place

You're not coming to Vietnam to escape your life. You're coming to feel what it's like when your body, the people around you, the food you eat, the sounds you hear, and the geography you occupy all move in the same direction.

That coherence is what creates change.

Da Nang is not the backdrop. The warm humidity, light sea air, these are structurally part of how your nervous system reorganizes.

Where you rest matters. How you move matters. What you eat matters.

EVIDENCE

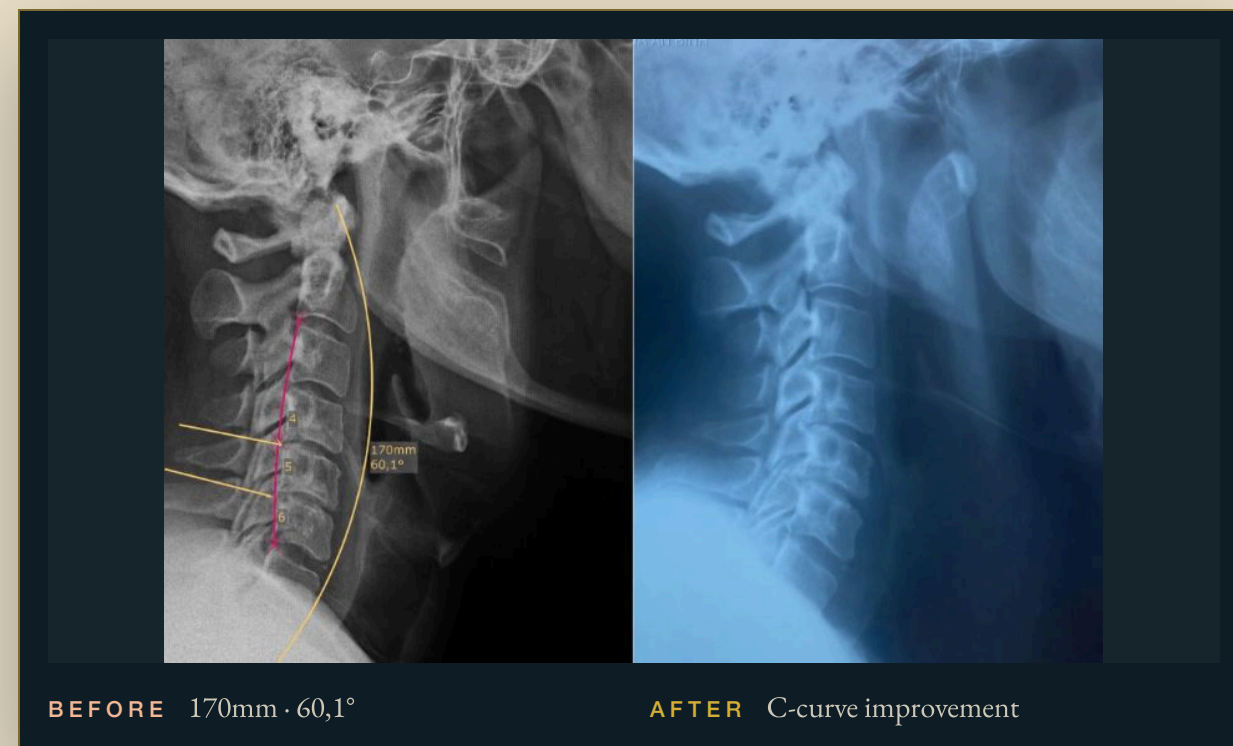
Why Measurement Matters

I'm not asking you to believe this through poetry.

I have X-rays. Before and after. Blood work showing measurable changes. Range of motion improvements. Documentation of stuck points releasing.

Not mystical. Not metaphorical. Measurable.

When you participate in ASCENSION, you're not betting on wellness marketing. You're entering a system validated through my own body.



Come because you're ready to stop choosing between systems and start integrating them.

Come because you want measurement, not metaphor.

Come because your body deserves to be understood as the unified, intelligent system it actually is.

CONTINUE YOUR ASCENSION

Answer the questionnaire and we will tell you which of the six pathways your body is asking for.



Explore the January 2027 Da Nang experience.

[ASCENSIONSENSES.COM](https://ascensionsenses.com)

Or write to daniel@stanfordemporium.com

Know someone ready to discover their pathway? [ASCENSIONSENSES.COM/JOIN](https://ascensionsenses.com/join)

GRAVITY IS SHAPING YOUR BODY.

YOUR FASCIA ADAPTS.
LEARN TO MOVE DIFFERENTLY.

ASCENSION
DISCOVER YOUR PATHWAY

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